



Cate has gone from wine to scotch an hour ago. She looks at her wristband watch, picks up her phone and checks the time. She flips through her Instagram without looking at anything. The dress feels too tight and too short. Too dressed up for this joint. She steals a glance around the room to see if anyone is staring. Nobody is. At every notification sound from her phone, she jumps, only to discover it is just a new political tweet or humorous post by some comedian she's been following. Nothing to do with her. Still no messages or calls. What did she expect? Why had she thought they would show up for this birthday?¹

¹Source: Pors, Eva. *Engelsklærerens Øvelsesbog*, Columbus, 2022